

Cloud Computing Technology for Marketing

Butler House- Kilkenny

**Module Code: B8IS114 CLOUD TECHNOLOGY FOR
MARKETING**

Module Leader: Mark Power

Student Name: Mihaela Cristina Stefanache

Student Number: 10633446

Word Count: 3753

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	2
Introduction.....	3
1. Research and Analysis of Butler House Kilkenny.....	3
1.1. Current Marketing Strategies:.....	3
1.2. Challenges.....	4
1.2.1 Competing with Other Luxury Accommodations and Event Venues	4
1.2.2. Reliance on third-party booking platforms	4
1.2.3. Limited ability to gather and use guest data	5
1.3. Goals	6
1.3.1. Increase direct bookings through the Butler House website.....	6
1.3.2. Personalize marketing efforts to attract both international and local guests.	6
1.3.3. Improve Customer Retention.....	7
2. Cloud Solutions Proposal for Butler House.....	7
2.1 Cloud Technologies for Marketing	7
2.2 Content Management Systems (CMS).....	9
2.3 CRM and Cloud Integration.....	10
2.4. Website Analytics and SEO.....	11
3. Implementation Plan for Butler House	14
Phase 1: Research and Setup (1-2 Weeks).....	14
Phase 2: System integration (3-4 weeks).....	15
Phase 3: Testing and Optimization (2-3 weeks)	16
Phase 4: Staff training and Launch (1 week)	17
4. Milestones	18
4.1. Resources	19
4.1.1. Technical Staff (IT Specialists & Web Developers).....	19
4.1.2. Marketing Specialists.....	19
4.1.3. Training resources.....	20
Annex	21
Reference list	27

Introduction

Butler House Hotel is in Kilkenny, Ireland. It was built in the 18th century and is characterized by offering luxury accommodations with a historic background. Kilkenny brings history, charm, romance and a warm welcome to all who visit.

1. Research and Analysis of Butler House Kilkenny

1.1. Current Marketing Strategies:

Heritage Branding: The Butler House Hotel in Kilkenny has considerable and rich historical significance in attracting customers, which is key to the marketing strategy. The building is inspired by Georgian architecture that is recognized for features like large bow windows and plasterwork ceilings that create a unique brand identity (Butler.ie, 2025). This Property is also associated with the Butler Family, Dukes and Earls of Ormonde. In addition to being part of Ireland's Blue Book, the Hotel further enhances its reputation as a charming and stylish hideaway. (Irelands-blue-book.ie, 2021)

Events and Weddings: Butler House has established itself as a premier venue for intimate weddings and special events, offering incredible experiences for different groups of guests. Butler's House provides different types of ceremonies and counts indoor and outdoor spaces in their Georgian Walled Garden to make them affordable for everyone. The Hotel offers different packages for civil ceremonies at Butler House that accommodate intimate ceremonies with as few as four guests, up to much larger celebrations for up to 60-120 guests depending on the ceremony (Butler.ie, 2025a), and humanist ceremonies that include barefoot or second-day BBQ. (Wedding Dates, 2020) This versatility in event hosting complements its heritage branding, creating a distinctive offering in the competitive Kilkenny hospitality market.

Email Marketing Strategies: Nowadays, Email Marketing play a crucial role in digital Marketing strategy. Butler's House Hotel includes email marketing and uses a newsletter subscription option on its website to build a customer database. (Butler.ie, 2025a) Butler House maintains continuous relationships with its guests, encourages repeat visits, and promotes its unique offerings cost-effectively by leveraging email Marketing

1.2. Challenges

Butler House in Kilkenny faces challenges in maintaining a competitive edge and improving guest experiences. Here is an explanation of the challenges:

1.2.1 Competing with Other Luxury Accommodations and Event Venues

The Hospitality sector is very competitive in Ireland. Butler's House Hotel operates in a competitive industry with similar services, offering events venue services. It is categorized as a luxury hotel in Kilkenny and nearby regions. Butler's House has three direct competitors in the market. First, Mount Juliet Estate (Marriott Bonvoy, 2025) offers customers beautiful event spacing and amenities, luxury meeting rooms, and high-quality services, which attract potential clients who want to make it away from Butler House. Other hotels like Lyrate Estate Hotel and Kilkenny Ormonde Hotel also provide similar amenities and services to attract the same clients (Tripadvisor, 2016). To stay at the top of customers' minds, Butlers House must continually innovate and add reasonable offers, family packages or seasonal discounts to appeal to discerning travellers and event planners.

1.2.2. Reliance on third-party booking platforms

Like many other hotels, Butler House uses third-party booking platforms (OTAs) to reach a larger audience. However, this reliance comes with drawbacks:

Commission Fees: A commission rate is the percentage of the total booking cost an online travel agent (OTA) charges. The commission that OTAs charge may vary according to the Hotel and third-party platforms. The range of commission may vary from 15% to 30% per booking, which can significantly reduce profit margins (scott@prenohq.com, 2024). In other words, Butler House loses one part of its potential revenue for every booking made through these platforms.

Limited Control Over Customer Experience: The Hotel can have less control over the customer satisfaction of service experience when those bookings are made through third-party platforms, like Bookings, Blue House, etc, as the customers usually write reviews on these websites, not in the Butler House Hotel. As a result, guests may experience longer resolution times for their issues, which can lead to low customer satisfaction (The Guestbook, 2024)

Prioritization in Overbooking Situations: When there is an overbooking, Hotels very often prioritize those bookings made directly from the hotels, which is a problem as the guests who booked through a third party(OTAs) are at a disadvantage. (The Guestbook, 2024)

1.2.3. Limited ability to gather and use guest data

It is essential to collect and analyze robust data to personalize guest experiences and marketing campaigns, but Hotels like Butler House face some challenges:

Data Accuracy and Collection: Small hotels usually struggle with data collection and up-to-date guest information accuracy. These can be caused by out-of-date information at the front desk, other touchpoints, or even a human mistake. This can result in incomplete or inaccurate information on guest profiles, making it difficult to personalize offers or conduct a marketing campaign. (Healey, 2023)

Balancing Personalization with Privacy: Having some limitations when collecting guest information is important, so it is crucial to balance personalizing guest experience and respecting their privacy. Often, guests agree with the Hotel to collect essential data as they appreciate personalized services, but excessive data collection can be perceived as invasive. (Rodrigues, 2023) Butler House must ensure that any collected data is used responsibly and with the guest's permission.

Data Management and Integration: In the Hospitality sector is important the data management and integration to keep accurate guest records. The hotel manages a lot of information from various resources, including bookings, marketing, and guest interactions, and this can result in inefficiency in maintaining data. Without a unified data platform, this can result in data silos, making it difficult to obtain a comprehensive view of guest preferences and behaviour. (CDP Institute, 2024) This ability makes it difficult to adapt new services and marketing efforts effectively (Revinat, 2023)

Marketing Efficiency: Ineffective data use can fail marketing campaigns and the identification of the wrong target market; this may lead to wasting resources on audiences that are not interested and failing to maximize return on investment. (Johansson, 2024)

1.3. Goals

Butler's House in Kilkenny should implement several key goals to enhance its hospitality and increase customer engagement. Butler House can focus on the following strategies:

1.3.1. Increase direct bookings through the Butler House website

User-Friendly Website: By implementing some changes, Butler House will ensure that the website is easy to use and provides transparent information about rooms, amenities, and booking processes. Guests can enjoy a better service experience and book directly with the Hotel by providing this service. (Sirvoy, 2024)

SEO and Content Marketing: The website should implement keyword optimization for Kilkenny and its attractions. Create engaging content that showcases the Butler Hotel's unique features and local experiences, which can attract both international and local guests.

Direct Booking Incentives: Butler Hotel can offer special discounts or perks to guests who book directly through the website, such as a complimentary upgrade or a free breakfast. (Sirvoy, 2024)

1.3.2. Personalize marketing efforts to attract both international and local guests.

Guest Profiling: Collect information on guest preferences to customize marketing campaigns. For instance, international visitors may be drawn to cultural happenings, whereas residents might value exclusive deals for weekend getaways. (Lacalle, 2023)

Event-Centric Marketing: Organize or engage in local events that attract both local and international visitors. This may encompass cultural celebrations, culinary events, or athletic competitions (Lacalle, 2021)

Geographic Targeting: Employ geofencing to reach potential guests according to their location. Improve customer retention and loyalty by engaging guests after their stay through personalized offers. For example, making personalized exclusive offers for Dublin guests or a second visit discount. (Direful, 2023)

1.3.3. Improve Customer Retention

Butler's House can start implementing new strategies to enhance customer retention. Some strategies that Butler can use are Loyalty programs to motivate the guest to come back to visit us, second and third visit exclusive offers, room upgrades for family or in a special celebration, early check in, or special packages.

As a way to grow the customer base and reward guest loyalty, Butler Hotel should offer discounts or extra services to encourage guests to refer friends or a family member. Enhancing the guest experience and strengthening brand loyalty can also be achieved by using guest feedback to create customized offers for their next visit or special deals during off-peak seasons. As well can also encourage the guest to reserve through their website on the next visit (Lacalle, 2023; Revivo Technologies, 2024)

2. Cloud Solutions Proposal for Butler House



2.1 Cloud Technologies for Marketing

Cloud tools help you to manage marketing activities for businesses like Butler House, a small business, much easier, faster, and more effectively. Marketing means a lot of tasks, organizations, and plans, such as tracking campaigns, reaching customers, and analyzing/interpreting results; thus, cloud-based tools simplify these processes, saving you time and hassle. (Hoesch, 2023) With cloud solutions, **Butler House can:**

- ⊂ Keep all marketing data in one place to make better decisions. (campaign results, budgets)
- ⊂ Automate simple marketing tasks to save time and avoid mistakes. (promotional e-mails, posting on social media, updating the website)
- ⊂ Give customers a more personal experience by using smart data insights. (tailored recommendations)
- ⊂ Help teams and partners work together more smoothly. (access to data anywhere, anytime)
- ⊂ Add or reduce resources when needed, which saves money. (during busy seasons, like holidays) (Hoesch, 2023)

❖ Benefits of Cloud Technologies

Flexibility: Butler House can adjust its marketing tools to handle busy seasons. (run special campaigns during peak periods)

Cost Savings: Cloud tools charge monthly fees, so there are no big upfront costs. (pay for only what they use)

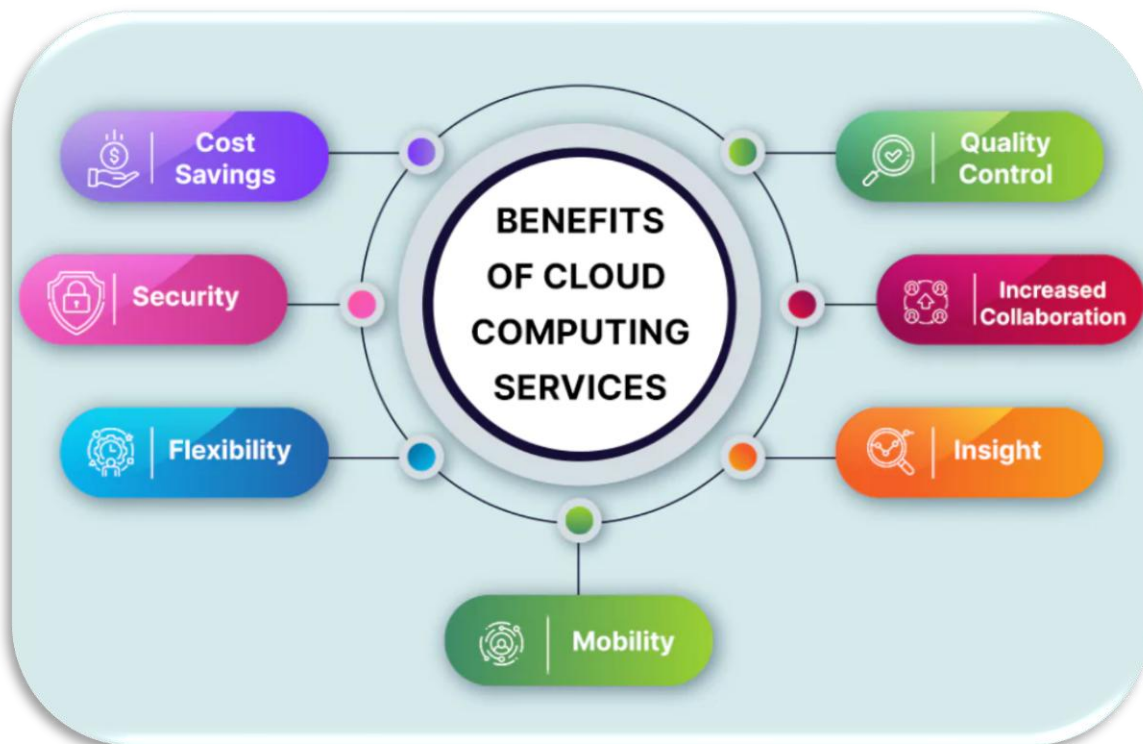
Easy Access: Teams can use these tools anytime, anywhere. (Internet connection required)

Security: Cloud platforms keep data safe and have backups to protect important information.

Room for Innovation: Butler House can explore new strategies like automated email campaigns, predictive analytics, and AI-driven tools. These keep marketing efforts fresh and help the business stand out. (IBM, 2021)

By adopting cloud technologies, according to Grogan (2024), Butler House can focus more on growth and guest satisfaction. These tools simplify the marketing process, reduce stress, and ensure that decisions are based on solid data. This approach helps Butler House attract new visitors, keep loyal guests happy, and maintain its reputation as a leading guesthouse in Kilkenny.

Picture 1, Cloud Benefits (Admin, 2025)



2.2 Content Management Systems (CMS)

Our recommendation for the Butler House from Kilkenny is **WordPress with WP Engine**. By choosing WordPress with WP Engine, Butler House will have a modern, secure, and user-friendly website that supports all marketing goals, enhances the guest experience, and helps them stand out as a top destination in Kilkenny. (Mailchimp, 2024) & (Sitecore, 2024)

Table 1, CMS

Why WordPress?	CMS Benefits for Butler House
Simple for Users: It is simple to construct and manage a site through WordPress, and this makes it possible for Butler House employees to oversee the changes without engaging any technical personnel. Whether I want to input new room occupancy, change the dates for an upcoming event, or update the blogs, it is a task that is simple for the staff members.	Better Engagement: Thanks to WordPress, Butler House can make an appealing design of its site, which is also easy to use. Guests don't have a lot of time to see the room information, check the room's status, or learn information about activities or places of interest.
Personalize: There are thousands of themes and a variety of colors in WordPress allowing Butler House to develop an appealing, fit-for-purpose, and well-polished website which meets their peculiar needs. They can integrate booking engines, picture galleries, etc., to render the website appealing and useful.	Time Savings: Employees can post website information by themselves, including seasonal offerings, outreach events, and services offered, without seeking assistance from IT personnel. This makes the website relevant and ready for the visitors.
SEO-Friendly: WordPress interacts well with SEO-optimizing tools like Yoast SEO. This also aids in the improvement of search results by comprehensively optimizing the content, meta-description, images, and even the URL so that in case a client wants to find a guesthouse in Kilkenny, Butler House will easily show up.	Easy Connections: Popular tools such as Salesforce CRM or Google Analytics or social networks are integrated with WordPress. Those integrations allow Butler House to observe customer activities, respond to requests and broadcast messages across the channels to win new clients.
Integration: Other applications such as CRM, analytics, booking engines and other programs can be utilized with ease on WordPress. As an example, a CRM can be automatically populated with customer information following a website inquiry.	Affordable: Compared to bespoke websites, WordPress and WP Engine are not expensive. The fact that plugins and add-ons can easily be implemented means that Butler House will be able to increase its functionalities later without costly remodelling.
Cloud Hosting: WP Engine makes sure the website is active and functioning. (Walden, 2022) & (Kassim, 2019)	Scalable and Reliable: With its WP Engine cloud hosting it is assured that the site can cope with large volumes of visitors during the holidays and other busy periods without stalling. It also shields the website from hacker attacks and a degree of inaccessibility. (Vedraj, 2024)

2.3 CRM and Cloud Integration

Proposed Cloud-Based CRM Solution: **HubSpot**



After looking at Butler House’s webpage and considering its needs and goals for future development, HubSpot CRM is the recommended solution. HubSpot is ideal for smaller businesses like Butler House that need an easy-to-use, affordable, and effective CRM. HubSpot offers an intuitive interface, allowing the hotel to manage guest data effectively. (Alfred, 2023) It integrates easily with any existing marketing tools and can help track customer interactions and preferences, thus personalising marketing campaigns/strategies. This CRM can enhance communication with past guests, leading to increased loyalty and repeat bookings. (Alfred, 2023) These cloud-based CRM can convert guest information from inquiries to bookings, or for example, if they stayed for a wedding, anniversary, or regular getaway and use this data to send personalized offers. (Alfred, 2023) & (HubSpot, 2023)

Key Features:

Set-up and Training Simplicity: All the technical hustle that HubSpot entails is unnecessary for Butler House’s staff since they do not require specialised technicians or any form of training, which makes it easy for them to incorporate the system almost instantaneously.

Embedded Marketing Tools: HubSpot combines CRM with tools for email marketing, social media management, and campaign tracking.

Automation: Self-explanatory as it automates things like follow-up emails, newsletters and even guest feedback requests.

Integration: Connects smoothly with the likes of WordPress, Google Analytics as well and social media.

Free and Scalable: HubSpot offers a free version with essential features and flexible paid plans for small, medium and large businesses. (HubSpot, 2023)

CRM Benefits for Butler House

Enhanced Customer Interaction: HubSpot allows Butler House to send specific guests individually customized messages, emails and offers according to their needs.

Information Consolidation: All guest information, booking information and interaction information are housed in a single place, which makes it easy to do follow-up.

Affordable Business Tool: The free and cheap rates of HubSpot are very good for smaller businesses such as Butler House.

Smooth Connectivity: HubSpot merges seamlessly with the current WordPress website and Google Analytics. (Baker, 2023)

2.4. Website Analytics and SEO

Cloud-Based Analytics Tools

Google Analytics 4 (GA4): According to Google Analytics (2024), GA4 is a useful cloud-based tool that monitors website activity. It offers detailed insights like where visitors come from, how they interact with the site, and which pages perform best. For Butler House, GA4 can help track conversions like bookings, identify popular content, and highlight areas that need improvement, as it is a tool focused on events and an analytic tracker. (Hemme and Tietgen, 2024)

HubSpot Marketing Hub: HubSpot offers built-in analytics tools that will help Butler House rate the performance/efficiency of email campaigns, landing pages, and social media posts. It allows easy tracking of customer journeys, giving insight into what marketing efforts attract the most bookings. (Baker, 2023)

SEO Tools

Yoast SEO (WordPress Plugin): Utilizing Yoast SEO is key for enhancing the search engine ranking of the Butler Houses website by optimizing page content like titles and images along with tags to ensure visibility in searches. (Yoast, 2024)

SEMrush: SEMrush is an SEO tool that operates in the cloud and offers capabilities for conducting keyword research and analyzing competitors and backlinks. It can identify high-ranking search terms like “Kilkenny guesthouse” and help Butler House outrank its competitors. (Pavlik, 2022)

SEO and Analytics Strategies

On-Page SEO Optimization: For example, if you use keywords that target specific audiences, such as tourists looking for “Irish Country House in Kilkenny”; “historic accommodations in Ireland”, or “unique surroundings in Kilkenny”. Optimising each page’s headers, titles, and descriptions so search engines recognise their relevance. (Pavlik, 2022)

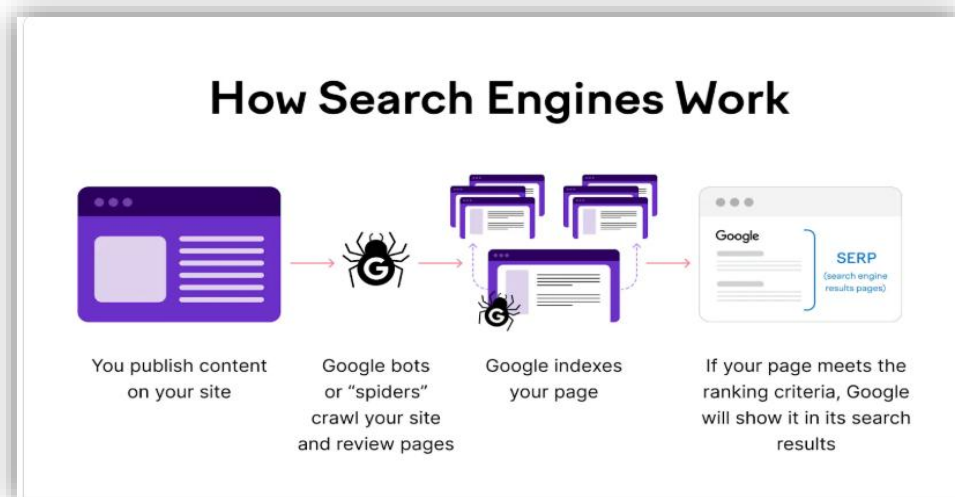
Local SEO: Enhancing Butler Houses' presence in the community through SEO involves optimizing its Google My Business profile with current contact details and attractive room photos, as well as listing upcoming events to prompt satisfied visitors to share positive feedback and boost its ranking. (Pavlik, 2022)

Performance Monitoring: Using GA4 to monitor metrics such as the percentage of visitors on the website, how much time spent on the site, and page views. Analyze which pages convert visitors into bookings and use this data to improve less/fewer effective pages. Google Analytics (2024)

Content Optimization: Content is key to attracting guests to Butler Houses website in Kilkenny by sharing informative blog posts about local attractions and seasonal events that pique their interest and improve search engine rankings. (Pavlik, 2022)

Mobile Optimization: Taking care of the website functions smoothly on smartphones since a lot of visitors will be using their phones to browse and enhance images. Speed up page loading times while also making the booking process mobile-friendly to boost guest conversions. (Pavlik, 2022)

Picture 2 SEO
(Pavlik, 2022)



Leveraging cloud-based CMS, CRM, and social media tools, according to Needle (2024) the following strategy enhances customer engagement:

Table 2, Content Calendar Strategies

Content Calendar Integration	Schedule posts via tools like HubSpot
Targeted Campaigns	Use Salesforce to segment customers and deliver targeted messages.
Interactive Campaigns	Promote events, special offers, and customer stories on platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn.
Performance Insights	Use analytics tools to track engagement and optimize campaigns.
Real-Time Analysis	Use GA4 and HubSpot to track social media referrals and performance.
Customer Insights	Integrate Salesforce CRM to analyze guest interactions and preferences.
Strategic Decision-Making	Use analytics data to refine content strategy, promotions, and event offerings.
Mobile-Friendly Campaigns	Create responsive email and social media campaigns using HubSpot Marketing Cloud or Salesforce.
Geotargeting	Use location-based ads to target visitors to Kilkenny (Needle, 2024)

This comprehensive cloud-based marketing solution improves Butler House to modernize its marketing approach, improve customer engagement, and drives revenue growth. By adopting a cloud-based CMS (WordPress with WP Engine), integrating HubSpot CRM, leveraging analytics tools, and enhancing SEO efforts, Butler House can deliver exceptional customer experiences across all channels. Additionally, targeted social, mobile, and contextual marketing strategies ensure effective communication and measurable results.

3. Implementation Plan for Butler House

The implementation plan is based on different phases that are going to help Butler House with better Setup, integration, optimization and launchmen with the new cloud tools such as CMR, CMS and analytic tools to give a better customer experience and service to differentiate from our competitors.

Phase 1: Research and Setup (1-2 Weeks)



Objectives:

- ⊞ Evaluate the marketing systems in place along with current data capture methods
- ⊞ Choose cloud vendors providers to host CMS, CRM and analytic tools (WP Engine, 2023)

-Key Actions:

- ⊞ Perform a complete analysis of the existing digital marketing processes, client data processes, and website traffic.
- ⊞ Specify the requirements of CMS, CRM, and analytics tools to facilitate integration. (Sprinkle Data, 2023)

-Choose vendors:

- ⊞ The WP Engine provided with WordPress will be the chosen CMS for better hosting and performance.
- ⊞ HubSpot will be the chosen CRM.
- ⊞ Google Analytics 4 (GA4) and HubSpot Marketing Hub will be the chosen analytics tools.
- ⊞ Schedule a project timeline and action items for team members. (WP Engine, 2023) & (HubSpot, 2023)

-Results:

- ⊞ Executed vendor agreements, documented requirements and system-identifying processes.
- ⊞ Finalized project roadmap.

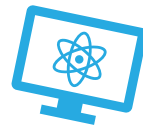
Phase 2: System integration (3-4 weeks)

Objectives:

- ⊂ Transition of the **Butler House** website to a cloud-based content management system (CMS).
- ⊂ Enable direct online booking as an integrated feature on the web page.
- ⊂ Set up a guest data collection and classification customer relationship management (CRM) system. (HubSpot, 2023)

Key actions:

- ⊂ Website Migration: Transfer all content, layout, and SEO work to WordPress using WP Engine.
- ⊂ Integration of the booking engine: Expanded and tested the online reservation system for direct bookings.
- ⊂ CRM Implementation:
- ⊂ HubSpot configuration for guest data capture.
- ⊂ Data segmentation by different users (weddings, events, ordinary stays).
- ⊂ Connection of email marketing tools for CRM.
- ⊂ Assurance of inter-system data works correctly. (LinkedIn, 2023), (HubSpot, 2023) & (WP Engine, 2023)



Results:

- ⊂ Websites are functioning on WordPress with WP Engine.
- ⊂ The booking engine is incorporated and works correctly.
- ⊂ CRM with classified guest data information completed and set up.

Phase 3: Testing and Optimization (2-3 weeks)

Objectives:

- ⊂ Make sure that the new digital infrastructure functions properly.
- ⊂ Enhance website capabilities along with CRM integration.
- ⊂ Try out personalized email marketing strategies.

Key actions:

- ⊂ Website Checking:
 - Conduct UX/UI assessments.
 - Verify all device compatibility.
 - Improve speed and security settings. (HubSpot Knowledge Base, 2023)
- ⊂ CRM Checking:
 - Confirm that data capture is correct.
 - Evaluate passive customer activities automation (email marketing, follow-ups and segmentation). (Sprinkle Data, 2023)
- ⊂ SEO and Analytic Supervision:
 - Improve website internal SEO.
 - Link GA4 and HubSpot for performance monitoring.
 - Make new tactics based on previously gathered data. (HubSpot, 2023)



Results:

- ⊂ The website is fully optimized and free from bugs.
- ⊂ The CRM system is incorporated into the marketing funnels.
- ⊂ Website's SEO requirements are accomplished.

Phase 4: Staff training and Launch (1 week)

Objectives:

- ⊂ Educate hotel staff on how to use CMS, CRM, and email marketing software.
- ⊂ Initiate the first marketing campaigns with personalized features.

Key actions:

- ⊂ Staff Training sessions:
 - Web instructor trains staff on CMS.
 - Staff is trained on HubSpot CRM by marketing consultants.
 - IT support assists with problems and questions. (WP Engine, 2023) & (HubSpot, 2023)
- ⊂ Campaign Execution:
 - Email campaigns based on fragmented data of different guests.
 - Encourage direct bookings through online advertising.



Results:

- ⊂ Staff are fully educated in the hotel's software.
- ⊂ First marketing campaigns with personalized features are operational.

4. Milestones

The keys to this project for the Butler House Hotel are divided into different phases that are designed to ensure a smooth and efficient transition to a cloud system, optimizing customer experience and enhancing the digital marketing strategy already created. From initial research and vendor selection to web migration, CRM integration and the launch of personalized email marketing campaigns, each milestone marks an impact point in the development of the project. (HubSpot, 2023)

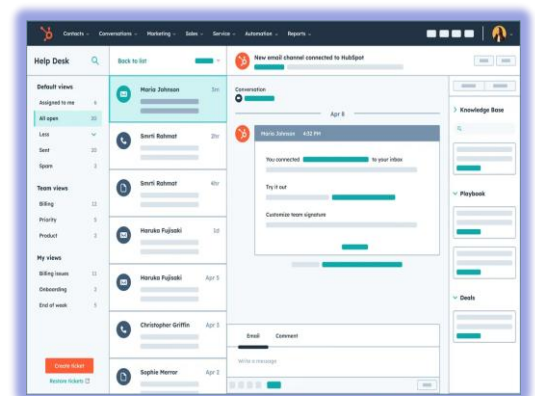
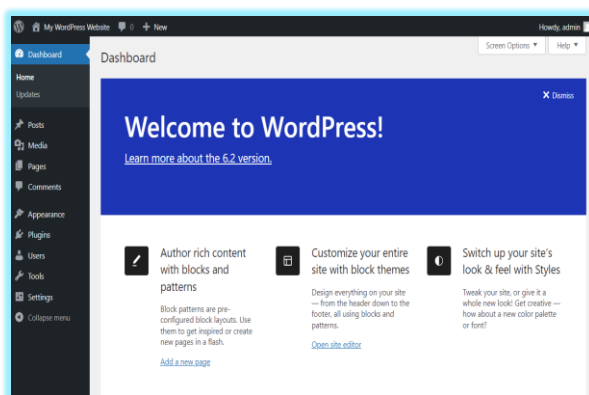
This will enable it to modernize its digital infrastructure and strengthen its market positioning, increasing customer interaction and improving customer experience.

Using HubSpot CRM facilitates data separation, allows for automated interactions, and develops unique marketing strategies. This system enhances customer relationship management by capturing the preferences of guests so that relevant communication can be sent to them, which improves retention rate (HubSpot, 2023).

Furthermore, using WordPress with WP Engine as CMS guarantees scalability, security, and efficient accessibility and management of content while ensuring an optimal performance of the website and experience for its user (WordPress, 2023). “A satisfied customer is the best business strategy of all” (Michael LeBoeuf, 1981).

Combining Google Analytics 4 and HubSpot Marketing Hub permits tracking data, analyzing visitor activity, and supervising the performance of the hotel, thus enabling the refinement of digital strategies to optimize direct bookings (Google, 2023).

[https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/create-](https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/create-pages/)
[pages/&https://www.hubspot.com/products/service/help-desk](https://www.hubspot.com/products/service/help-desk)



4.1. Resources

4.1.1. Technical Staff (IT Specialists & Web Developers)

- **Web Developer**: Their duties include designing email templates in line with best practices, working closely with the social media team to ensure platforms are fully optimized, gathering user requirements to design relevant pages across different platforms, providing technical solutions, and developing cross-browser and cross-platform compatible solutions. (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2022).
- **IT Specialist**- The integration of CRM (HubSpot) and automation tools (GA4 and HubSpot Marketing Hub) is done while taking care of the system's data security, transportation, and efficiency (Google, 2023).



Cloud Hosting Administrator- Looks after the server uptime

as well as the customer data protection means, website downtime during traffic peaks, and implementation of the backup means. (Google, 2023) <https://en.ryte.com/magazine/google-analytics-4/>

4.1.2. Marketing Specialists

- **Digital Marketing Consultant**: Calculates and executes SEO strategies, PPC campaigns, and social media marketing efforts to amplify website traffic and direct bookings (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2022).
- **CRM & Email Marketing Specialist**: Takes advantage of HubSpot CRM to analyze customer information, implement targeted email marketing, and create automated communication strategies and use copywriting to achieve a better engagement. (HubSpot, 2023).
- **Content Creator**: Writes articles and participates in formulating marketing pages and advertisements to increase customer activity. (Google, 2023)

4.1.3. Training resources

CRM training - HubSpot

- ⊆ HubSpot Academy offers different specialized training for beginners and helps you in the whole process of the implementation of the digital tool. (HubSpot, 2023).
- ⊆ Marketing specialists and customer service teams will be trained in data segmentation, email automation, and customer interaction tracking (HubSpot, 2023).
- ⊆ Staff will learn to use HubSpot's analytics tools to understand the function of it.

CMS Training (WordPress with WP Engine):

- ⊆ Web developers will provide training sessions on how to update website content, manage images, and optimize blog posts.
- ⊆ Learn to navigate the CMS dashboard, track website performance, and troubleshoot minor issues (WordPress, 2023).
- ⊆ Create a functional website that works correctly according to Google's preferences.

Analytics training (Google Analytics GA4):

- ⊆ Learn to see the data you've collected in the available reports and how to customize reports for your specific use cases. (Google, 2023)
- ⊆ Staff will be guided on how to make data-driven decisions based on customer journey insights. (Google Analytics Help, 2023)
- ⊆ Knowledge of the Google Analytics tool to understand the data gathered and use it to improve the struggling points of the company. (Google Analytics Help, 2023)

In Conclusion, the implementation of all these steps and strategies will enhance customer engagement and boost sales performance. Butler House will be prepared and adequate to face the demands of today's digital world and face its competitors on a better level while adding a personalized experience, improving customer retention and enhancing the booking rates.

Annex

Team Meeting Timeline Report

Date: December 2024

Agenda: To decide what type of business we want to research.

Contributors: The Team (Rachel, Cristina and Hector)

1. Select an Organization: (HOSTEL)

Choose a real or hypothetical organization (e.g., a retail store, a tech startup, or a non-profit organization).

Discussions: The team researched small and medium online businesses, and each one of us came up with a top 3 names to choose from per our assignment requirements. Our group agreed to go forward with Butler House from Kilkenny, a small hospitality business that hosted weddings as well. The tasks were divided among our team from Rachel oversaw the Research and analysis of the business, Cristina was in charge of the Cloud Solution Proposal, and Hector was responsible for the Implementation plan.

Estimated Time Involved: 2 Hours

Date: Middle of December to End of January 2025

Agenda: Research on Butler House-Kilkenny

Contributors: Rachel

2. **Research and Analysis:** Conduct a detailed analysis of the organization's current marketing strategies, challenges, and goals. Evaluate the organisation's existing technologies and identify areas where cloud computing could provide improvements or solutions.

Discussion: Rachel had to conduct detailed research on Butler House to have a better understanding of the business and to identify the areas that needed improvement and solutions.

We all agreed and came up with a plan to follow to understand this business and what it needed to be done: **Analyze of its:**

- Current marketing strategies (e.g., digital ads, social media, traditional marketing, etc.)
- Challenges (e.g., reaching target demographics, competition, scalability)
- Goals (e.g., growth, brand awareness, market penetration)
- Existing technologies (CRM systems, CMS, e-commerce platforms, etc.)

After the semestrial break, Rachel presented us with the findings:

Research and Analysis: Butler House

1. Current Marketing Strategies:

- **Heritage Branding:** As a historic property, Butler House emphasizes its heritage, luxury accommodations, and beautiful gardens in its marketing. They likely use their website, social media, and online travel platforms like Booking.com or TripAdvisor to attract guests.
- **Events and Weddings:** Butler House is also popular for events, particularly weddings, which is another important aspect of their marketing strategy.
- **Email Marketing:** Sending promotional emails to past guests about upcoming events, special offers, and seasonal packages.

2. Challenges:

- Competing with other luxury accommodations and event venues in Kilkenny and nearby regions.
- Reliance on third-party booking platforms, which reduces profit margins due to commission fees.
- Limited ability to gather and use guest data to personalize experiences and marketing campaigns.

3. Goals:

- Increase **direct bookings** through the Butler House website.
- Personalize marketing efforts to attract both international and local guests.
- Improve **customer retention** and loyalty by engaging guests after their stay through personalized offers.

4. Estimated Time Involved: 1 month

Date: February 2025

Agenda: Cloud Solution

Contributor: Cristina

5. Cloud Solution Proposal :

- After the Research presented by Rachel, we had to discuss the development of a proposal for a cloud-based marketing solution that addresses the organization's needs. The meeting was held online on Skype as it suited everyone where we discussed potential cloud-based CMS and justified their choice. We all agree that further research and understanding of the topic was required.
- In order to understand and figure out what best suits The Butler House I had a better look at what Rachel shared with us, and we did in class many hours of CMS, the tools, CRM systems, and SEO. In the light of these new pieces of information and explanations from class, I did my own research online and I found the content I needed to and started a structure with examples of cloud-based CMS, CRM and SEO.

I shared the next structure with my team:

Cloud Solution Proposal for Butler House

1. Cloud Technologies for Marketing:

Cristina explained how cloud solutions can address the organization's marketing needs and the benefits of adopting cloud technologies. The group discussed various cloud technologies and their potential impact on marketing efficiency and effectiveness.

- **AWS or Google Cloud:** These cloud services can store and analyze guest data to create personalized marketing campaigns. With cloud-based marketing tools, Butler House could send tailored promotions to guests based on their past stays, interests, or special events like weddings.
- **Marketing Automation:** Using cloud-based platforms like **HubSpot** for automated marketing workflows (e.g., sending follow-up emails after events, seasonal offers, or promotions for weddings).

2. Content Management System (CMS):

Cristina recommended a cloud-based CMS (e.g., WordPress) and justified the choice based on the organization's requirements, such as scalability, ease of use, and integration capabilities. The group agreed on the recommendation.

- **Recommendation: WordPress with WP Engine hosting.**
 - **Why?** WordPress is ideal for managing the Butler House website because it offers flexible templates, is SEO-friendly, and allows non-technical staff to update content easily. WP Engine provides fast, secure hosting, ensuring the site performs well under high traffic, which is key during wedding seasons or events.
 - A **booking system integration** within the CMS could encourage direct bookings, reducing dependence on third-party platforms.

3. CRM and Cloud Integration:

Cristina proposed a cloud-based CRM solution and explained how it can be integrated with existing systems to improve customer relationship management and streamline processes. The group discussed the integration process and potential challenges.

- **Recommendation: HubSpot CRM or Zoho CRM.**
 - **Why?** These cloud-based CRMs can centralize guest information, from inquiries to bookings. By integrating with the website and booking systems, the CRM could track guest preferences (e.g., if they stayed for a wedding, anniversary, or regular getaway) and use this data to send personalized offers.
 - CRM integration can also improve **event management** by tracking communications with wedding planners, vendors, and guests.

4. Website Analytics and SEO:

Cristina also suggested tools and strategies for implementing cloud-based analytics (e.g., Google Analytics) and improving SEO. The group discussed the importance of analytics and SEO in the overall marketing strategy.

- **Google Analytics** for tracking website traffic, booking conversion rates, and user behaviour. The insights gained from this data can help optimize the booking process and improve the website's user experience.
- **SEO Tools: SEMrush** can be used to improve Butler House's search engine rankings. By targeting keywords related to luxury accommodation, weddings, and events in Kilkenny, Butler House can attract more organic traffic and improve visibility.
- Additionally, Butler House can create blog content around "things to do in Kilkenny," history of the house, or wedding tips, boosting SEO while highlighting its unique features.

All of this information was discussed and presented within the team as well as agreed on.

Estimated Time Involved: 1 month

Date: End of February to Middle of March 2025

Agenda: Implementation Plan

Contributor: Hector

4. Implementation Plan (5%): Provide a high-level implementation plan, including timelines, key milestones, and resources required.

For the implementation plan, we held a Skype meeting where we discussed a potential timeline and a structured plan for the proposed CRM solution and analytics tools. We all had a better understanding of the challenges of the integration plan and decided that further pieces of information and examples were required, which Hector had to investigate more. The proposed plan presented and agreed on:

1. Phase 1: System Integration (3-4 weeks):

- Integrate the Butler House website to a cloud-based CMS (WordPress with WP Engine).
- Integrate the booking engine to enable direct bookings via the website.
- Set up CRM (HubSpot) to capture and segment guest data (weddings, events, regular stays).

2. Phase 2: Testing and Optimization (2-3 weeks):

- Test the new website features, such as direct booking and event inquiry forms.
- Test CRM integration for personalized email marketing campaigns.
- Monitor and optimize website analytics and SEO performance.

3. Phase 3: Staff Training and Launch (1 week):

- Train staff on the use of the CMS, CRM, and email marketing tools.
- Launch personalized marketing campaigns, such as offers for wedding guests or seasonal stay packages.

4. Phase 4:

- Website migration complete with direct booking system.
- CRM integration live with guest data captured.
- Personalized email marketing campaign launched (e.g., for past wedding clients).
- Website SEO optimized for key search terms related to luxury stays and events in Kilkenny.

5. Resources Required:

- **Web developer:** For CMS setup, booking engine integration, and SEO optimization.
- **Marketing consultants:** For CRM setup and personalized marketing campaign design.
- **IT support:** To oversee cloud hosting and integration of cloud-based services.
- **Training resources:** To ensure staff can manage the CMS, CRM, and cloud-based marketing tools.

After all of us finished our part in the written Report, we agreed that each one would continue with the PPT as their next task and prepare for the Presentation.

Reference list

Admin (2025) *What is Cloud Computing? Definition, Benefits, Types, and Trends*.

<https://www.theinfinityhub.com/blog/cloud-computing>. [Accessed 22 Feb.2025]

Alfred, L. (2023). *15 Key Integrations Between CRM & Your Other Business Processes*. [online]

blog.hubspot.com. Available at: <https://blog.hubspot.com/sales/crm-integration> [Accessed 21 Dec. 2024].

Baker, K. (2023). *12 Key Benefits CRM Systems Provide to a Business*. [online]

blog.hubspot.com. Available at: <https://blog.hubspot.com/sales/benefits-of-crm> [Accessed 21 Dec. 2024].

Butler.ie. (2025a). *Contact Us | Butler House*. [online] Available at:

<https://www.butler.ie/contact-us.html> [Accessed 8 Mar. 2025].

Butler.ie. (2025b). *Exclusive Bespoke Wedding Venue Kilkenny Ireland | Private Venue Hire*.

[online] Available at: <https://www.butler.ie/intimate-wedding.html/1000> [Accessed 8 Mar. 2025].

Butler.ie. (2025c). *The History of Butler House | Butler House Hotel*. [online] Available at:

<https://www.butler.ie/the-house.html> [Accessed 6 Mar. 2025].

CDP Institute -. (2024). *Hospitality Data Management Problems? Meet Your Solution - CDP*

Institute. [online] Available at: <https://www.cdpinstitute.org/ascent360/hospitality-data-management-problems-meet-your-solution/> [Accessed 9 Mar. 2025].

Chaffey, D. & Ellis-Chadwick, F. (2022). *Digital Marketing: Strategy, Implementation and*

Practice. 8th edn. Pearson Education.<https://www.pearson.com/se/Nordics-Higher-Education/subject-catalogue/marketing/Chaffey-Digital-Marketing-8e.html> [Accessed 22 March 2025].

Coursera. (2023). *Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate*. Available at:

<https://www.coursera.org/professional-certificates/google-data-analytics> [Accessed 15 March 2025].

Direful (2023). *In today's fiercely competitive hospitality industry, the key to success lies in personalization. Hotel managers worldwide are discovering that tailoring their marketing campaigns to individual guest preferences can make all the difference.* [online] LinkedIn.com. Available at: <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/6-must-know-strategies-personalized-hotel-marketing-campaigns-gwdye/> [Accessed 10 Mar. 2025].

Google (2023). *Google Analytics 4 Overview.* Available at: <https://analytics.google.com> (Accessed: 5th March 2025).

Google (2023). *Meet the next generation of Google Analytics - Analytics Help.* [online] support.google.com. Available at: <https://support.google.com/analytics/answer/10089681?hl=en> [Accessed 21 Dec. 2024].

Google Analytics (2024). *Analytics Tools & Solutions for Your Business - Google Analytics.* [online] Google. Available at: <https://marketingplatform.google.com/about/analytics/> [Accessed 21 Dec. 2024].

Google Analytics Help (2023) *Understanding Google Analytics Reports.* Available at: <https://support.google.com/analytics/> (Accessed: 2nd March 2025).

Grogan, R. (2024). *How cloud computing can benefit SME businesses.* [online] Groganryan.ie. Available at: <https://www.groganryan.ie/monthly-newsletter/48-how-cloud-computing-can-benefit-sme-businesses.html> [Accessed 18 Dec. 2024].

Healey, R. (2023). *Navigating the Challenges of Personal Data Collection in Hotels: | Formiti.* [online] formiti.com. Available at: <https://formiti.com/navigating-the-challenges-of-personal-data-collection-in-hotels/>.

Hemme, K. and Tietgen, S. (2024). *GA4 or alternatives? How to choose your data analytics tracking tool.* [online] Diconium.com. Available at: <https://diconium.com/en/blog/ga4-alternatives-how-to-choose-your-data-analytics-tool> [Accessed 21 Dec. 2024].

Hoesch, G. (2023). *How Cloud Technology Can Improve Your Marketing Strategy.* [online] Dragonfly Digital Marketing. Available at: <https://dragonflydm.com/how-cloud-technology-can-improve-your-marketing-strategy/> [Accessed 18 Dec. 2024].

HubSpot (2023) *HubSpot Overview*. Available at: <https://www.hubspot.com> (Accessed: 21 Dec. 2024). HubSpot Knowledge Base (2023) *Integrating Google Analytics with HubSpot Content*. Available at: <https://knowledge.hubspot.com> (Accessed: 22 . 2025).

HubSpot (2023) *HubSpot Overview*. Available at: <https://www.hubspot.com> (Accessed: 15 March 2025).

HubSpot (2024) Help Desk Software. Available at: <https://www.hubspot.com/products/service/help-desk> (Accessed: 24 March 2025).

HubSpot, W. (2023). *Salesforce Service Cloud vs HubSpot | Customer Service Software*. [online] Hubspot.com. Available at: <https://www.hubspot.com/comparisons/salesforce-service-cloud-vs-hubspot-service-hub> [Accessed 21 Dec. 2024].

IBM (2021). *Cloud computing benefits*. [online] Ibm.com. Available at: <https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/cloud-computing-benefits> [Accessed 18 Dec. 2024].

Intellyo (2023) *Best Practices for Integrating CMS with CRM Systems*. Available at: <https://intellyo.com> (Accessed: 23rd Feb. 2025).

Ireland 's-blue-book.ie. (2021). *Butler House | Kilkenny Hotel | Blue Book*. [online] Available at: <https://www.irelands-blue-book.ie/houses.html/butler-house> [Accessed 5Mar. 2025].

Johansson, A. (2024). *Data Dilemma: Is the Hospitality Industry Lagging Behind?* [online] www.demandcalendar.com. Available at: <https://www.demandcalendar.com/blog/data-dilemma-is-the-hospitality-industry-lagging-behind>.

Kassim, S. (2019). *WordPress is better than other CMS - 5 main reasons behind it*. [online] WebsoftGlobal. Available at: <https://websoftglobal.com/why-wordpress-is-better-than-other-cms/> [Accessed 20 Dec. 2024].

Lacalle, E. (2021). *7 hotel marketing strategies to boost your bookings*. [online] www.mews.com. Available at: <https://www.mews.com/en/blog/hotel-marketing-strategy>.

Lacalle, E. (2023). *How personalization in hotels improves guest experience*. [online] www.mews.com. Available at: <https://www.mews.com/en/blog/personalization-in-hospitality>.

LeBoeuf, M. (1981) *How to Win Customers and Keep Them for Life*. Berkley Books. WordPress (2023) *WordPress and WP Engine Solutions*. Available at: <https://wpengine.com> (Accessed: 22 March 2025).

LinkedIn (2023) *Best Practices for CRM Integration*. Available at: <https://www.linkedin.com> (Accessed: 23rd Feb. 2025).

Mailchimp, I. (2024). *What is a CMS? A Guide to Content Management Systems*. [online] Mailchimp. Available at: <https://mailchimp.com/resources/what-is-a-cms/> [Accessed 18 Dec. 2024].

Marriott Bonvoy. (2025). *Mount Juliet Estate, Autograph Collection*. [online] Available at: <https://www.marriott.com/en-us/hotels/kkyak-mount-juliet-estate-autograph-collection/events/> [Accessed 4 Mar. 2025].

Needle, F. (2024). *4 Social Media Calendar Tools to Plan All of Your Content [Template]*. [online] Hubspot.com. Available at: <https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/social-media-calendar-tools> [Accessed 23 Dec. 2024].

Needle, F. (2024). *4 Social Media Calendar Tools to Plan All of Your Content [Template]*. [online] Hubspot.com. Available at: <https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/social-media-calendar-tools> [Accessed 22 March 2025].

NI Business Info. (n.d.). *The advantages of using a content management system*. Available at: <https://www.nibusinessinfo.co.uk/content/advantages-using-content-management-system> [Accessed 20 March 2025].

Oracle. (2024). *Why CRM is important*. Available at: <https://www.oracle.com/uk/cx/what-is-crm/why-crm-is-important/> [Accessed 24 March 2025].

Pavlik, V. (2022). *What Is SEO? Meaning, Examples & How to Optimize Your Site*. [online] Semrush Blog. Available at: <https://www.semrush.com/blog/what-is-seo/> [Accessed 22 Dec. 2024].

Revinate (2023). *3 steps to overcoming your hotel data management problems*. [online] Revinate. Available at: <https://www.revinate.com/blog/solving-hotel-data-management-problem-3-steps/>.

Revivo Technologies (2024). *As a hotelier, it's obvious to ponder over how to get guests back, and you must have drafted a strategy to accomplish the same. In case, your strategy fails to work, there's no need for you to panic as we bring you the best hotel guest retention strategies that have worked wonders when it comes to b.* [online] LinkedIn.com. Available at:

<https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/8-proven-hotel-guest-retention-strategies-revivo-tech-a2ccc/>

[Accessed 9 Mar. 2025].

Rodrigues, M. (2023). *Personalization vs Privacy - What do Hotel Guests Prefer?* [online] Guest Centric. Available at: <https://blog.guestcentric.com/personalization-vs-privacy-what-do-hotel-guests-prefer/>.

Ryte (2024) Google Analytics 4 – The Complete Guide. Available at:

<https://en.ryte.com/magazine/google-analytics-4/> (Accessed: 24 March 2025).

scott@prenohq.com (2024). *How Much Commission Does Airbnb, Expedia and Booking.com Take (+ Others).* [online] Preno HQ - Hotel Management Software. Available at:

https://prenohq.com/blog/ota-commission-rates-expedia-booking-com-more/#elementor-toc_heading-anchor-12 [Accessed 9 Mar. 2025].

Sirvoy (2024). *Skyrocket Direct Bookings – 4 Proven Strategies* |. [online] Sirvoy Booking System - Sirvoy is an easy-to-use booking system for hotels and other types of accommodations offering Property Management System, Booking Engine and Channel Manager. Available at:

<https://sirvoy.co.uk/blog/2024/05/22/direct-bookings/> [Accessed 10 Mar. 2025].

Sitecore, C. (2024). *How to choose the right CMS.* [online] Sitecore.com. Available at:

<https://www.sitecore.com/explore/topics/content-management/how-to-choose-a-cms> [Accessed 18 Dec. 2024].

Sprinkle Data (2023) *Best Practices for CRM Analytics.* Available at:

<https://www.sprinkledata.com> (Accessed: 25th February 2025).

The Guestbook (2024). *Written By: Jesse Linevsky In my strategy and innovation role at The Guestbook, I've learned quite a few things about hotel reservations. Here I want to go over how best to approach booking your upcoming trip, whether it's for business or your well-deserved PTO.* [online] LinkedIn.com. Available at: <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/what-really-happens-when-you-book-your-hotel-through-third-ew34f/> [Accessed 9 Mar. 2025].

Tripadvisor. (2016). *Tripadvisor*. [online] Available at: https://www.tripadvisor.ie/HotelsNear-g186616-d552327-Butler_House-Kilkenny_County_Kilkenny.html [Accessed 9 Mar. 2025].

Vedraj (2024). *10 Reasons Why WordPress is (STILL) the Best CMS*. [online] Value Coders | Unlocking the Power of Technology: Discover the Latest Insights and Trends. Available at: <https://www.valuecoders.com/blog/technology-and-apps/10-reasons-why-wordpress-is-better-than-other-cms/> [Accessed 20 Dec. 2024].

Walden, H. (2022). *WordPress vs Everything Else: The Ultimate CMS Showdown*. [online] Elegant Themes Blog. Available at: https://www.elegantthemes.com/blog/wordpress/wordpress-vs-everything-else?utm_source=Blog&utm_medium=Manual%20Divi%20Targets&utm_campaign=Google%20Search&retargeting=off&gad_source=1&gclid=CjwKCAiAgoq7BhBxEiwAVcW0LCdyUwAqaSZg5BnPJFZDfBHPbB7qzzgwP22KP_5WJMtH86nQ18EthoCWaEQAvD_BwE [Accessed 20 Dec. 2024].

Wedding Dates. (2020). *Butler House & Garden*. [online] Available at: <https://www.weddingdates.ie/venue/butler-house-garden-kilkenny-city-kilkenny-15237/> [Accessed 8 Mar. 2025].

WordPress (2024) How to Create Pages. Available at: <https://wordpress.org/documentation/article/create-pages/> (Accessed: 24 March 2025).

WP Engine (2023) *WP Engine Solutions*. Available at: <https://wpengine.com> (Accessed: 21 Dec. 2024). WP Beginner (2023) *How to Setup HubSpot Analytics in WordPress*. Available at: <https://www.wpbeginner.com> (Accessed: 27 Feb. 2025).

Yoast, T. (2024). *Yoast SEO*. [online] WordPress.org. Available at: <https://wordpress.org/plugins/wordpress-seo/> [Accessed 22 February. 2025].